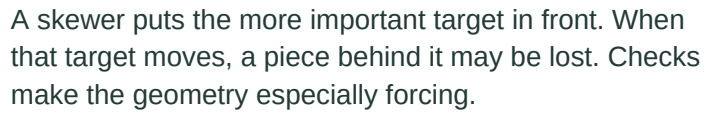


Skewers

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on e3. Geometrically undefended: rook on a3. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

48...Rg3+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **49.Kf4**.

49...Rxa3 The rook captures the rook on a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.